FINE LIVING
RESTAURANT

RED HOT BEAUTIFUL

Scarlett House, Malaika Arora's debut restaurant in Mumbai, offers elegance from a disappeared world, with some of her favourite food and glow potions. What else can you ask for?

By Nivedita Jayaram Pawar





Scarlett House, a 90 year old bungalow, stands on a quaint Bandra bylane whispering tales of a bygone era. A narrow, woody staircase leads to a living room festooned with gramophones, floral-upholstered Victorian chairs and vintage dinnerware. Nostalgia hangs heavy in the air, and a sense that you have entered a cosy, lived-in Bandra home. But it's not! Scarlett House is Malaika Arora's new restaurant with restaurateur Dhaval Udeshi, her son Arhaan and Malaya Nagpal.

Apart from a charming dining room, the restaurant also features a wine & cheese room and a small retail counter beaming with locally-sourced cheeses, nut butters and other items largely sourced from women entrepreneurs. A seductively low-lit lounge, clad with dreamy wall paper and cascading chandeliers, sits on a higher floor. Though the tables may feel treacherously close, it's undoubtedly glamourous. There's background jazz music but it's unobtrusive and doesn't drown out a lively hum of chatter.

In a place where food needn't impress, it still does. The menu at Scarlett House holds some favourites from Malaika's kitchen but is largely the work of chef Beena Noronha, who also helms Udeshi's other restaurants including GIGI. Springy calamari curled up alongside fried coconut bits was a delight. There's also thecha smeared paneer full of bite and vigour. The Malabar Curry with Indrani rice felt like